

Michael Lindon

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EDUCATION

Duke University

PhD Statistics, MSc Statistics

Durham, NC

August 2012 – May 2018

University of Warwick

MPhys Physics, BSc Physics

Coventry, UK

August 2008 – May 2012

EMPLOYMENT

Staff Research Scientist

Netflix

November 2020 – Present

New York, NY

- I was on the experimentation platform team for 4 years under Martin Tingley, and for the last two years I have been on the machine learning inference research team reporting to Nathan Kallus
- Co-creator of Netflix's Real-Time A/B Testing Platform**
From inception, I co-developed Netflix's real-time experimentation platform in close partnership with Observability Engineering. The platform unifies large-scale stream processing with sequential hypothesis testing, enabling statistically rigorous monitoring of software health metrics during client deployments. Its original mandate was to provide real-time detection of metric degradation, allowing releases to be automatically aborted or rolled back while maintaining strict, anytime-valid guarantees on false detection rates. These "canary" experiments are now embedded as a final gate in Netflix's deployment pipeline and have become a standard best practice for production releases.
The system supports hundreds of metrics, including continuous latency measures (e.g., PlayDelay [9]) and high-volume count outcomes (e.g., successful play starts and start-play errors [6]), and safeguards thousands of production releases each month.
Over time, the platform expanded beyond deployment safety to provide real-time guardrail monitoring for all A/B testing at Netflix. It now protects business-critical metrics spanning quality of experience, customer support, live events, and advertising. In addition to leading the statistical methodology, I served as product owner for the platform, defining the roadmap, aligning stakeholders, and partnering with multiple vertical teams to onboard new metrics and use cases.
- Developed the Anytime-Valid Theory of Linear Models Powering Analysis**
Before I arrived at Netflix, the experimentation platform had made heavy investments into using linear regression as the standard method of analysis. In order to facilitate sequential analysis on the core platform, I wrote a paper on how to do anytime-valid linear regression [5], which has been submitted to JASA.
- Foundational Research in Sequential Analysis** I have a paper that proves asymptotic Type I error calibration and stopping-time optimality of mixture SPRT tests [1], and my paper with my 2024 intern on sequential causal inference from a design-based perspective has just been accepted to Management Science [2]. I am currently working with the Ads team to develop methodology for the sequential analysis of conversion and brand lift, where outcomes are typically delayed and may be differentially accelerated by interventions [7].

Staff Statistician

Optimizely

August 2019 – November 2020

San Francisco, CA

- At optimizely I developed a sequential sample ratio mismatch test which was published at Neurips [8] and resulted in two patents [4, 3]

Senior Data Scientist

Tesla

June 2018 – July 2019

Fremont, CA

REFERENCES

- [1] A. BIBAUT, N. KALLUS, AND M. LINDON, *Near-optimal non-parametric sequential tests and confidence sequences with possibly dependent observations*, 2024 (Submitted to Annals of Statistics).
- [2] D. W. HAM, I. BOJINOV, M. LINDON, AND M. TINGLEY, *Design-based confidence sequences: A general approach to risk mitigation in online experimentation*, 2023 (Accepted to Management Science).
- [3] M. LINDON, *A/b testing sample ratio mismatch solver*, 1 2023. Application number: 17077812.

- [4] —, *A/b testing using sequential hypothesis*, 2 2023. Application number: 17077911.
- [5] M. LINDON, D. W. HAM, M. TINGLEY, AND I. BOJINOV, *Anytime-valid linear models and regression adjusted causal inference in randomized experiments*, 2024 (Submitted to Journal of American Statistical Association).
- [6] M. LINDON AND N. KALLUS, *E-processes for sequential hypothesis testing of point processes*, in AISTATS, 2025.
- [7] —, *Anytime-valid inference under outcome delay: A design-based approach*, 2026.
- [8] M. LINDON AND A. MALEK, *Anytime-valid inference for multinomial count data*, in Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems, A. H. Oh, A. Agarwal, D. Belgrave, and K. Cho, eds., 2022.
- [9] M. LINDON, C. SANDEN, AND V. SHIRIKIAN, *Rapid regression detection in software deployments through sequential testing*, in Proceedings of the 28th ACM SIGKDD Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining, KDD '22, New York, NY, USA, 2022, Association for Computing Machinery, p. 3336–3346.

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